Rules and Regulations for Traditional Archery

Annexure I. Applies to every archery tournament on traditional bamboo equipment, by any organiser, anywhere in the Kingdom.

Article I — Dimension of the Bacho (archery field)

1. For safety, the Bacho should ideally be 200 metres long, leaving a safe distance of 25 metres behind each target area, and at least 20 metres wide excluding space for spectators on either side.
2. No public thoroughfare of any kind, including vehicle parking, is allowed within this area.
3. If 200 metres cannot be obtained, a wall at least 6 metres high, topped by a 2-metre wire mesh with the smallest possible eyes, should be erected behind each target area. The wall should be at least 10 metres wide.
4. If provision for spectators is required, the width of the area shall be increased to at least 40 metres.
5. An archer safety barrier at least 2 metres long and 2 metres high should be erected on both sides of the Bacho, preferably of a material that protects archers without breaking arrows.
6. The outer perimeter should be fenced off if the range is in an urban or highly populated area.
7. Signboards should warn the public of the range, and precautions taken so that no one walks, drives or parks within the designated area.
8. Other measures required by the particular location of the range should also be put in place.
9. The distance between the two targets shall be 140 metres for traditional equipment.

Article II — The target

1. The target shall be 120 cm (4 feet) high at the longest point, 40.64 cm (1 foot 4 inches) wide and 3.81 cm (1.5 inches) thick for traditional equipment.
2. The Gorthig (bull’s eye) shall be 6 cm in diameter, its centre marked 30 cm (1 foot) from the crown of the target.
3. Targets should preferably be blue pine, with hard knots removed and the holes stuffed with soft wood.
4. Strong white cotton cloth is glued over the entire surface as a base for painting and to stop the target splitting as kareys accumulate.
5. The painting usually consists of rainbow colours around the bull’s eye, with water and a five-petal lotus pattern at the bottom. Other patterns may be permitted.

Article III — Composition of teams

1. Each team shall consist of 13 players including two substitutes.
2. No more than two seeded players are allowed in a team.
3. An archer who has played for one team in a tournament may not join another team in the same tournament.
4. Each team is led by a captain, who is the focal person for communication with the Thrimpon (umpire).
5. Names, CID numbers and copies of the CID of every player shall be submitted with the entry application on the team application form prescribed by BIGSA.
6. If a team withdraws after paying entry fees and submitting names, its players may not play for any other team in that tournament.

Article IV — Arrival and entry into the Bacho

1. Every member of the teams playing on a given day shall arrive at the reporting area before the reporting time for roll call, without entering the playfield.
2. A team arriving after the reporting time is liable to a deduction of 11 points.
3. The two teams enter the Bacho together when told to by the Thrimpon, led by their captains, step for step, players following in a straight line.
4. Teams proceed straight to the mid-point of the Bacho for roll call and briefing. Any player violating this rule costs the team 5 points.
5. A player entering the Bacho before the designated time costs the team 5 points, for each player who does so.
6. A player leaving the Bacho without the Thrimpon’s permission costs the team 5 points, and a further 11 points on returning.
7. If any of the 13 players cannot report for roll call, the captain shall inform the Thrimpon in writing before entering the roll-call area.

Article V — Roll call, substitution and replacement

1. Teams must have the minimum number of players present at roll call or be disqualified; no Lagtheb is allowed.
2. After roll call players go to their team tents with bows and arrows inside the bow case and quiver; violation costs 5 points.
3. No Drachen arrow may be shot from inside or outside the team tent; violation costs 5 points.
4. Substitution during a match requires the permission of the Thrimpon on duty.
5. If a team is likely to fall below the minimum of 11 players, the captain may request a replacement player in writing on the BIGSA form at least a day before. The Thrimpon decides on the merits and informs the opposing captain. Alternatively, the tournament committee decides on the Thrimpon’s recommendation.
6. In an emergency, a seeded player may be replaced by another seeded player following the same procedure.

Article VI — Captains’ meeting and the fixture

1. At a meeting of team captains the player lists of all teams are read out, to make sure no player appears in two teams and no team has more than two seeded players.
2. Copies of the written rules are made available so captains can brief their players.
3. The fixture is drawn in the presence of team captains or representatives and the organising committee, and may only be changed by that meeting.

Article VII — Time of match

1. Teams report by 07:30 in summer and 08:00 in winter (or as specified), and enter the Bacho together at 07:45 and 08:15 respectively.
2. Matches start at 08:00 in summer and 08:30 in winter, and close at 18:00 in summer and 17:00 in winter, with a lunch break from 12:00 to 13:00.
3. If a match is undecided at closing time, play continues until all players of both teams have shot. A match still undecided continues the next day; if undecided by 12:00 on the second day, other matches at that venue are postponed.
4. Play may be suspended for rain or snow at the Thrimpon’s discretion.
5. No archer or team may practise on the tournament Bacho during the tournament, including rest days.
6. A coin toss decides which team chooses the shooting end; the ends then remain for the whole match.

Article VIII — Score keeping

1. Each captain designates two players, appointed by the Thrimpon as scorers, who together determine the points scored each round.
2. Two organiser score keepers are placed at the two ends — one confirms who hit the target, the other reconfirms at the end of the round — and record kareys and points, using walkie-talkies.
3. No other player may interfere with the karey record or scoring; violation costs 5 points.

Article IX — Counting of points

1. Karey: an arrow point properly stuck in the front of the target, clearly above the ground (including when only the Dachag remains) — 2 points.
2. Gorthigbu-karey: a hit clearly inside the bull's eye without touching its outline — 3 points.
3. Gyegdi-phogpai-karey: an arrow that skids along the ground and sticks firmly in the target — 2 points, provided it stays in the target when the Thrimpon lifts it vertically.
4. Nawpog-karey: an arrow that pierces the side of the target and hangs from it — 2 points if hanging free; if any part touches the ground, 1 point is deducted from the opponent's karey, as with a Sa-karey.
5. Sa-karey: a hit on the lower target with the arrow through the ground, or covered by soil or grass, that stays when the target is lifted — 1 point, and supersedes a Droreg-ureg.
6. Zheychha-gangm: a direct hit where the arrow does not stay in the target — 1 point.
7. Droreg-ureg: a hit on the side of the target with the fletch, shaft or nock touching the target — 1 point.
8. Daya: an arrow embedded in the ground close enough to be measured with an arrow (nock to tip) — 1 point, provided no opposing Daya is closer. Near-equal distances are settled by Chhumipai-zam, measuring with a small stick.
9. A karey or Daya shot with an arrow belonging to the opposing team scores for neither team.

Article X — The game

1. The team winning the toss chooses the target end and team tent. Where there is more than one Bacho, teams first toss for the Bacho.
2. Ends chosen hold for the day; matches continuing over several days toss again each morning.
3. Each game is complete when one side reaches 25 points. The first team to win 2 games wins the match (best of three).
4. Appointment of Thrimpons is the prerogative of the organiser.

Article XI — Customary practices

1. Encouraged: Marchhang at the start of the match, Chhang-phued before and after, Dachham as per tradition, folk songs, Bjibi Pawo and the victory ceremony.
2. Prohibited: Nemsey-phangsum; Chorthap-dripthap; Drachhen-korni and shooting Drachhen arrows anywhere within the Bacho; bringing religious items such as images, Dhar or Tsendar to the Bacho; inviting astrologers; and any disturbance to the Bacho before or during a match.
3. Lighting any fire within the Bacho for spiritual intervention is strictly prohibited — 10 points are deducted.
4. Physical contact intended to distract an archer is prohibited.
5. Stabilisers, sights and mechanical release aids are not allowed, as decided by the 73rd National Assembly. Anyone using them may not practise on public Bachos or play in tournaments.

Article XII — Code of conduct and discipline

1. All players wear the national dress during play. Caps, hats or head-dress cost 1 point per occasion.
2. Players stand on either side of the Bacho; only the archer about to shoot steps onto it (1 point per violation).
3. Only archers in the match may enter the Bacho area.

4 Violence or quarrelling costs 2 points and may be reported to the police.
5 One Dachham per karey; more costs 1 point.
6 Smoking and drinking in the play and public area cost 5 points; mobile phones in the Bacho area cost 5 points per violation.
7 No player under the influence of intoxicants may play. Every player signs the BIGSA code of conduct form before the tournament.
8 Points the two scorers cannot decide go to the Thrimpon, whose decision is final.

Article XIII — Safety

1 Every player gives the highest priority to their own and others' safety, including spectators.
2 Arrows are released only when all players are outside the flag poles or in the safe area.
3 A player who stays inside the Bacho to distract the opposing archer costs the team 1 point.
4 An archer who draws sideways or skywards above shoulder level is banned from public Bachos.
5 A player who becomes a serious safety threat is barred from the match; one who hits another player or spectator is banned for life.
6 An archer who accidentally kills a person can be charged under Section 144 of the Penal Code of Bhutan for negligent homicide.

Article XIV — Settlement of disputes

1 Disputes beyond the Thrimpon's powers go to a dispute settlement committee constituted before each tournament.
2 Disputes of a criminal nature are referred to the Royal Bhutan Police.

Article XV — Players' code of conduct

1 Respect archery as part of our rich tradition and unique cultural heritage, and uphold its rules at all times.
2 Treat officials, players and spectators with respect and dignity, and show true sportsmanship on and off the ground.
3 Refrain from foul language, unsportsmanlike behaviour, and drinking or smoking in public.
4 Foster patriotism, team spirit and mutual respect.

Article XVI — Definitions

1 Substitute player: one of the 13 players of a team who can replace any player during play for tactical reasons, with the Thrimpon's permission.
2 Replacement player: a player not in the original 13, inducted in extraordinary circumstances when a team falls below the minimum of 11.